

Assignment Instructions



AI 201 — ASSIGNMENT BRIEF
Project 2: The Reactive Sandbox

You are the Systems Designer. Build three connected panels that share a single brain.

Due Date	Weight	Submission	Type
Mon, April 27, 2026	30% of Final Grade	GitHub Pages (live URL)	Individual

Milestone Schedule

Session	Date	Milestone
Session 7	Mon 4/13	Design Intent due. Define your domain, your data model, and the rules for all three panels.
Session 8	Wed 4/15	Forging the Prefabs. AI builds your three isolated components. Layout and structure first.
Session 9	Mon 4/20	★ FIRST PLAYABLE. State is centralized. Clicking in one panel updates the others. Working, not perfect.
Session 10	Wed 4/22	Faking the Lore. AI generates JSON data to populate your system. Make it feel real.

Session 11	Mon 4/27	The Juice. Micro-interactions, transitions, and polish. How does it <i>feel</i> to click your UI?
Session 12	Wed 4/29	★ STUDIO CRIT + DELIVERABLE DUE. Desk presentations. Show the system working. Defend your architecture.

The Assignment

Build a system of three connected UI components that share a centralized state model. When something changes in one panel, the others react. You choose the domain. The architecture is the constant.

Your three components each demonstrate a different interaction pattern:

- **The Browser** — Lets the user explore, filter, or select from a collection. Tapping an item updates the shared state.
- **The Detail View** — Reveals deeper information about the selected item. Reacts instantly when the selection changes.
- **The Controller** — Lets the user take action that changes state across the entire system. The Browser and Detail View both respond.

The state requirement: All three components read from and write to shared state. This is the architectural spine regardless of domain.

Example Domains

The architecture is the same. The skin is yours. Here are starting points:

Domain	Browser	Detail View	Controller
Game UI	Card grid / spell deck	Card stat panel	Deck builder controls
Contracting	Job board	Job detail / estimate	Schedule + assign
PM Dashboard	Task board	Task detail	Status + priority
Sports Media	Player roster	Player stats card	Lineup / compare
Portfolio / UX	Project gallery	Case study panel	Filter + view controls

What You Turn In

A live, interactive three-panel system hosted on GitHub Pages, plus the following documentation. Everything ships together.

- **Live Reactive Sandbox URL** — Three connected, interactive UI components sharing centralized state. Hosted and accessible. When you click in one panel, the others respond.
- **Design Intent** — Your creative and architectural spec written before AI engagement. Domain choice, data model, visual rules for each panel, state flow description. This is the standard against which you evaluate everything AI produces.
- **Mermaid Diagram** — System flow: how the three panels connect, where state lives, what triggers updates. In your GitHub repo.
- **AI Direction Log (3–5 entries)** — What you asked AI to do, what it produced, what you changed/rejected/kept and why. README, annotated commits, or sketchbook.
- **Records of Resistance (3 moments)** — Three documented moments where you rejected or significantly revised AI output. What did AI produce? Why did you reject it? What did you do instead?
- **Five Questions Reflection** — Short paragraph in your README or sketchbook. Completed before submission.

Grading (100 pts)

Category	Pts	Meets Expectations	Below Expectations
Live Reactive Sandbox	30	Three panels share centralized state. Clicking in one panel visibly updates the others. Atmosphere, typography, and layout create a unified experience. Hosted and accessible.	Panels are disconnected or state is duplicated. No visible cross-panel reactivity. Broken or not hosted.
Design Intent	15	Clear domain choice, data model, visual rules for each panel, and state flow description. Written before AI coding. Specific enough to evaluate AI output against.	Vague, written after the fact, or missing. No clear standard for evaluating AI work.

Mermaid Diagram	10	Accurate system flow showing how the three panels connect, where state lives, and what triggers updates. Matches the built project.	Missing, inaccurate, or does not reflect the actual project.
AI Direction Log	15	3–5 entries showing what was asked, produced, and decided. Demonstrates editorial judgment.	Missing, fewer than 3 entries, or generic (“I used AI for help”).
Records of Resistance	15	3 documented rejections/revisions. Each names what AI gave, what you did instead, and why.	Missing or shallow. No real evidence of critical evaluation.
Five Questions	10	Honest, specific responses. Demonstrates self-awareness about the process.	Missing, perfunctory, or clearly written without reflection.
Studio Crit Presentation	5	Can walk through the system and explain architecture decisions. Engages with crit. Shows one moment of resistance live.	Cannot explain choices. Reads from notes. Disengaged from peer feedback.
TOTAL	100		

How to Submit

- Push your final code to your GitHub repository.
- Verify your live GitHub Pages URL works in an incognito browser window.
- Ensure your README contains: Design Intent, AI Direction Log, Records of Resistance, Five Questions reflection, and your Mermaid diagram (or link to it).

- Submit your GitHub Pages URL to Blackboard under the Project 2 assignment.
- OPEN PROJECT: The examples above are starting points, not a menu. Your domain is yours to define. If your three-panel system serves your discipline, your portfolio, or your side project, it belongs in this assignment. The architecture is the constant; your world is the variable. Bring your idea to Session 7 and we will scope it together.
- STUDIO CRIT PROMPT: “Show me one moment where you rejected what AI gave you and explain why.”

See also: **The Reactive Sandbox — Context & Framework** for architecture examples, ESF practices explained, the Art Director framing, tips, and academic policies.

Submission *DISCLOSURE: Document created with AI assistance (Claude, Anthropic) for formatting and rubric scaffolding. All pedagogical decisions, content, and assessment criteria directed by Professor Tim Lindsey. Directive Memo authored without AI, per SCAD ESF Protocol.*

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